

REFERENCE · ILLUSTRATIVE SEED SET

Direct calls vs. bus-stop strings: real carrier rotations on one map

9 real, currently published named container services (Maersk's AE-series Asia-Europe network, CMA CGM's MEDEX and BIGEX 1) drawn as their own rotations – not an exhaustive model of global container shipping, a seed set to extend. For a specific origin/destination pair, `logjam carrier-route` answers the same question as a table: is there a direct service, and if not, how many stops.

By Michael Schertz Tooling `logjam` (open-source) Generated 15 Sep 2026 Source IMF PortWatch
Method see § Method & provenance

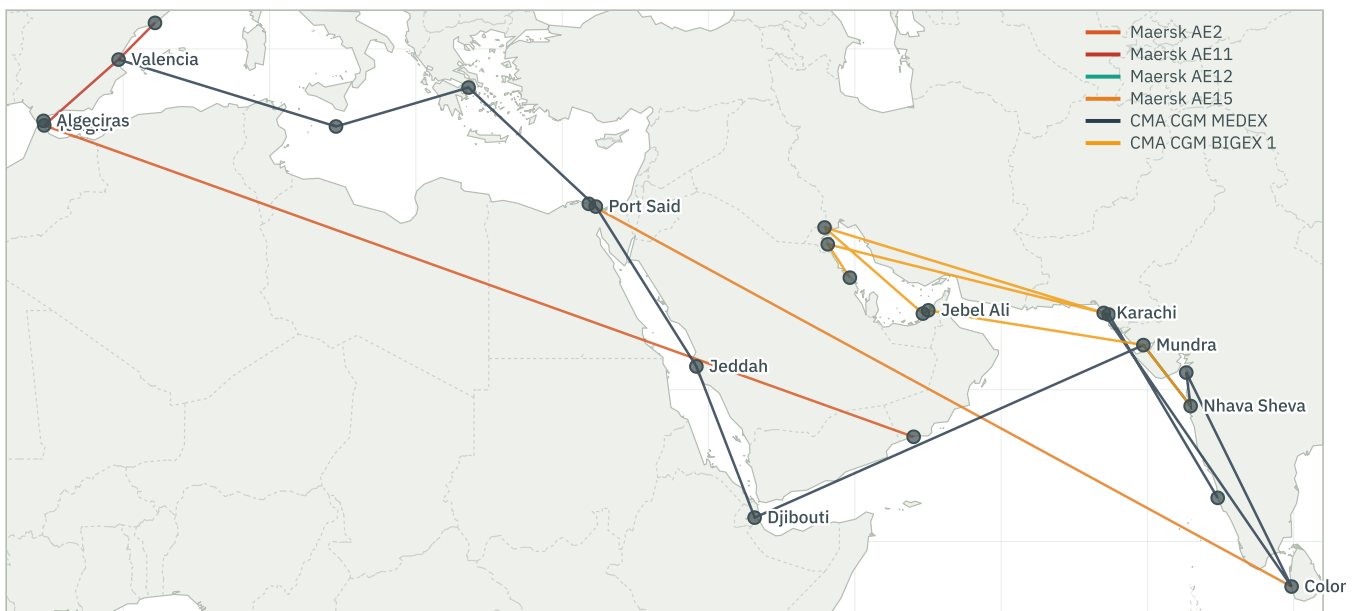
SERVICES PLOTTED 6 of 9 loaded	CARRIERS 2 Maersk, CMA CGM
PORTS ON THIS MAP 23 In this basemap's frame	PUBLISHED TRANSIT TIMES 1 of 9 services Only CMA CGM MEDEX publishes a from/to matrix; the rest show a distance-based estimate, always labeled as such

§ 1 Nine real services, one frame

Every line is a real, currently published carrier rotation — not a simplified trade-lane arrow. 6 of 9 loaded services have at least two calls inside this basemap's frame and are drawn; the rest (Maersk's Asia-Europe strings, which spend most of their rotation in the Far East and North Europe) mostly fall outside it. Where a service's rotation leaves and re-enters this frame, the drawn line connects only its in-frame calls, in sailing order — it does not draw the great-circle path through the ports this basemap can't show.

Carrier rotations

Real published named container services, Middle East / Red Sea / Indian Ocean frame



Maersk AE2 Maersk AE11 Maersk AE12 Maersk AE15 CMA CGM MEDEX
CMA CGM BIGEX 1

Basemap: Natural Earth 10m (public domain), the same 'corridor' window used by the Suez & Red Sea brief. Hover any port for the services calling there. Ports referenced by a loaded service but outside this basemap's frame, and so not shown: Aarhus, Antwerp, Bremerhaven, Fos, Genoa, Gothenburg, Gwangyang, Hamburg, Koper, La Spezia, London Gateway, Ningbo, Qingdao, Rijeka, Rotterdam, Shanghai, Southampton, Tanjung Pelepas, Vado Ligure, Wilhelmshaven, Yantian.

§ 2 Direct call or bus stop? Ask a specific pair

This map answers 'where do these services go'; it doesn't rank them for a specific shipment. For that, `logjam carrier-route "<origin>" "<destination>"` finds every loaded service touching both ports, in that sailing order, and reports whether it's a direct call or how many stops sit between them, plus a real transit time where the carrier publishes one (currently only CMA CGM MEDEX) or a clearly labeled distance/speed estimate otherwise. Example: `logjam carrier-route "Djibouti" "Piraeus"`.

Every loaded service				
CARRIER	SERVICE	ROUTE	CALLS PLOTTED	REAL TRANSIT DATA
Maersk	AE1	Cape of Good Hope	1/9 in frame	no – CLI shows an estimate
Maersk	AE2	Cape of Good Hope	2/9 in frame	no – CLI shows an estimate
Maersk	AE3	Cape of Good Hope	0/9 in frame	no – CLI shows an estimate
Maersk	AE5	Cape of Good Hope	1/9 in frame	no – CLI shows an estimate
Maersk	AE11	Cape of Good Hope	3/10 in frame	no – CLI shows an estimate
Maersk	AE12	Suez Canal	2/8 in frame	no – CLI shows an estimate
Maersk	AE15	Suez Canal	3/8 in frame	no – CLI shows an estimate
CMA CGM	MEDEX	Suez Canal	13/15 in frame	yes (MEDEX-style matrix)
CMA CGM	BIGEX 1	Gulf (intra-regional, no Suez/Cape transit)	8/8 in frame	no – CLI shows an estimate

Ports plotted and how many loaded services call there	
PORT	SERVICES CALLING HERE

PORT	SERVICES CALLING HERE
Tangier	3
Algeciras	3
Valencia	2
Port Said	2
Colombo	2
Mundra	2
Nhava Sheva	2
Karachi	2
Salalah	1
Barcelona	1
Damietta	1
Malta	1
Piraeus	1
Jeddah	1
Djibouti	1
Hazira	1
Port Qasim	1
Mangalore	1
Jebel Ali	1
Khalifa Port	1
Umm Qasr	1
Shuaiba	1
Jubail	1

§ Method & provenance

Every figure in this brief is reproducible from a local database built by the open-source `logjam` tool and a single generator script. Nothing is hand-transcribed.

WHAT THIS IS

A small, hand-curated seed set of real named container-service rotations, fetched from carrier network publications (Maersk's own Asia-Europe network update page; CMA CGM's own MEDEX and BIGEX 1 service flyers) in September 2026 — not derived from PortWatch, not an exhaustive model of global container shipping. See `src/logjam/resources/carrier_routes.yaml` for each service's exact source and to add more.

DIRECT VS. STOPS

Counted from each service's own published rotation order, walking forward from origin to destination, wrapping at most once around the loop (a real weekly string repeats). The reverse pair can match the same service with a different stop count — going the long way round costs more — so it is not assumed symmetric. A port a service reaches only 'in transshipment' (its vessel doesn't call there directly) doesn't count as a stop.

REAL VS. ESTIMATED TRANSIT TIME

Only CMA CGM's MEDEX service publishes a from/to transit-time matrix (its April 2026 flyer, non-contractual). Every other service here has no published transit time; both this report and the `carrier-route` CLI command show a distance/speed estimate instead (great-circle distance along the sailed path ÷ an assumed 18kn) and label it 'estimated', never blending it with a published figure.

BASEMAP

The 'corridor' basemap (the same one the Suez & Red Sea brief uses) — the widest of the three basemaps this tool has built. Most of the Maersk Asia-Europe strings' Far East / North Europe calls fall outside its frame and aren't drawn; see §1.

REPRODUCE

```
uv run python scripts/reports/carrier_routes_2026.py . Full method in  
docs/METHODOLOGY.md .
```

Limitations

- Nine services is a seed set illustrating the idea, not a survey of global container shipping — most carriers' most services aren't modeled here.
- Only CMA CGM MEDEX has a published transit-time matrix; every other transit time shown anywhere in this report or the CLI is a distance/speed estimate, and a rough one — it counts steaming time only and excludes port dwell, so it understates any real multi-stop transit.
- MEDEX's own published matrix is not required to arithmetically reconcile with the simplified single-pass rotation order used for stop-counting — CMA CGM's own flyer shows MEDEX as a

pendulum string calling some ports more than once per loop, which the simplified order here doesn't reconstruct. See the comments in `carrier_routes.yaml`.

- Port coordinates are approximate port-city lookups, not PortWatch-sourced, and are not used anywhere else in this tool.
- Ports outside the 'corridor' basemap's frame are not drawn: Aarhus, Antwerp, Bremerhaven, Fos, Genoa, Gothenburg, Gwangyang, Hamburg, Koper, La Spezia, London Gateway, Ningbo, Qingdao, Rijeka, Rotterdam, Shanghai, Singapore, Southampton, Tanjung Pelepas, Vado Ligure, Wilhelmshaven, Yantian.

Michael Schertz · built with [logjam](#), an open-source logistics bottleneck & opportunity identifier
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